tions are false which either are due to defects in our sense organs or are later on sublated. But all other cognitions are *ipso facto* true.[1]

Kumārila goes on to add that if cognitions did not have this 'Sakti' of self-validity, nothing could produce it in them. If the validity of a cognition is made to depend upon conditions other than itself, the process would lead to an infinite regress without establishing the validity of cognition at all. Hence the 'Svataḥ-prāmāṇyan' of all cognitions. While in other systems of epistemology, it is the truth of a cognition which has to be ascertained, in Mīmāṁsā epistemology on the contrary, it is their falsity which has to be established. The validity of an apprehension cannot come from outside 'parataḥ,' and even when a cognition is later on sublated and disproved, it only disproves the validity that originally belonged to the previous cognition. If validity did not already belong to the previous cognition, it could not later on be set aside.

The question now is, how is this theory of the 'Svataḥpramāṇatva,' i.e., the intrinsic validity of cognitions related to the 'Svataḥ-prakāṣatva' or the intrinsic cognizability of cognitions. It seems reasonably clear that the two theories mutually imply one another and are complementary, if not actually identical. To say that a cognition is inherently valid is only to say that it is self-luminous. 'Svataḥpramāṇatva' means only 'Svataḥjnanatva.' Just as when one has perceived an object, he does not doubt that he has perceived that object, similarly, one does not doubt that when he has cognized he has cognized an object; the reason being, that in both cases, cognition or awareness carries its own revelation along with itself. If cognitions were not self-luminous and had to depend for their own cognizability upon other conditions, then their intrinsic validity too, could not be immediately and directly established. In fact, the concept of the intrinsic validity of cognition presupposes the intrinsic cognizability of cognitions, if any distinction at all can be made between the two concepts of 'Svataḥpramāṇatva' and 'Svatāḥprakāṣatva.'

One looks in vain for anything more than the self-luminosity in the concept of self-validity. Self-validity hardly means anything more than self-cognizability, which is the same as Dharma-Kīrti's famous assertion that if one does not believe in the cognition as directly cognized, one could not establish the cognition of anything. Besides, almost the very same argument of infinite regress and the impossibility of apprehension apply against the theory of non-self-luminosity of cognitions which are advanced against the extrinsic validity of cognitions. Our point is that hardly any difference of importance can be made between the two concepts of 'Svataḥpramāṇatva' and 'Svaprakāṣatva.'